

Work Description--Short Film Sound Design

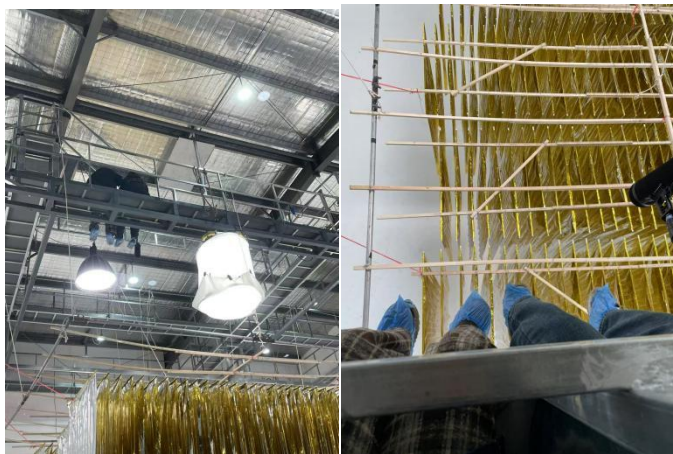
Brief introduction of story: The short film "Tidal Surge" is set in 2044, a time when advanced AI has caused people to lose emotional connections. To address this, 719 scientists created a device called "Tidal," which allows them to share consciousness seamlessly, achieving a level of communication beyond physical limits. The protagonist, Ye Ling, a team leader, is called to investigate when "Tidal" suddenly cuts off all external contact. During the mission, he discovers the truth about the device while reflecting on family, belief, and the meaning of existence.

This original film's sound production process, from live recording to post-production, was carried out through collaboration between my friend Jiaqi Liu and me.

Synchronization recording: The filming process lasted five days. The first two days were in a white studio where we used lavalier microphones hidden inside team helmets to reduce noise caused by movement.



For "Tidal" device scenes, we recorded mechanical sounds using a Zoom H5 recorder and created Foley effects using gold foil. We faced issues with background noise from another studio, which led us to re-record some audio in a car after filming.



The remaining days were spent in an abandoned air-raid shelter in Huzhou. We faced challenges such as limited breaks, cold conditions, and bats in the cave.



However, with good teamwork, we completed the filming smoothly.



Post-production: I worked on dialogue editing, environmental soundscapes, Foley, special sound effects, and music composition. For the environment, I used surround sound techniques to enhance realism, such as adding wind effects to lab scenes and applying reverb to simulate the echoing cave. For the music, inspired by "Arrival", "Tenet", and "The Wandering Earth", I used the Serum synthesizer to create an electronic score that matched the film's sci-fi tone. For example, during mission briefings, I added alarm-like sounds to increase tension.



This project taught me the value of sound in storytelling, especially in shaping atmosphere and emotions. It deepened my understanding of how sound design connects the audience to the narrative on a deeper level. We won the second prize, 9th Sound Academy Awards (Excellent Work Category) by the Sound Committee of the China Society of Film and Television Technology for the film *Tidal Surge* in December 2024

